

Tiptop Virtual Academy Capability Model

What the Academy Must Be Able to Do

Version: 2.0 Foundation Draft

Purpose

The Capability Model defines the enduring abilities that Tiptop Virtual Academy must possess in order to fulfill its mission.

Capabilities describe **what the Academy must be able to do**, not **how** it does it.

Unlike organizational structures, software systems, workflows, or job descriptions, capabilities remain stable as the institution evolves.

Every investment, policy, process, technology platform, AI capability, and organizational improvement should strengthen one or more institutional capabilities.

Capability Principles

A capability:

- Exists independently of technology.
 - Exists independently of organizational structure.
 - Exists independently of individual employees.
 - Can improve over time.
 - Can be measured.
 - Can be supported by people, processes, information, AI, and technology.
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Tier 1 — Strategic Capabilities

These capabilities define the Academy itself.

Institutional Governance

The ability to provide vision, leadership, governance, policy, ethical oversight, strategic planning, and institutional direction.

Educational Excellence

The ability to design, deliver, evaluate, and continually improve high-quality education.

Institutional Sustainability

The ability to remain financially, operationally, academically, and socially sustainable over time.

Innovation

The ability to continuously improve educational experiences, operations, and services through thoughtful innovation.

Tier 2 — Core Educational Capabilities

These are the capabilities that directly fulfill the Academy's mission.

Attract Learners

The ability to reach, engage, and inspire prospective students and families.

Admit Learners

The ability to evaluate applications and make fair, transparent admission decisions.

Enroll Learners

The ability to transform accepted applicants into active students.

Deliver Learning

The ability to provide engaging, structured, and meaningful educational experiences.

Assess Learning

The ability to evaluate learner progress accurately, fairly, and constructively.

Support Learners

The ability to provide academic, emotional, and operational support throughout a learner's journey.

Develop Learners

The ability to nurture intellectual, personal, ethical, digital, and social growth.

Recognize Achievement

The ability to acknowledge progress, celebrate success, and certify accomplishment.

Tier 3 — Family Capabilities

Build Trust

The ability to establish confidence between families and the Academy.

Communicate Effectively

The ability to share accurate, timely, and meaningful information.

Engage Families

The ability to create lasting educational partnerships with parents and guardians.

Resolve Concerns

The ability to receive, investigate, and resolve issues fairly and promptly.

Tier 4 — People Capabilities

Recruit People

The ability to identify and attract outstanding employees.

Develop People

The ability to improve professional capability through training, mentoring, and experience.

Evaluate Performance

The ability to measure contribution, provide feedback, and support continuous growth.

Retain Talent

The ability to create an environment where excellent people choose to remain.

Tier 5 — Financial Capabilities

Price Services

The ability to establish sustainable and equitable pricing.

Manage Billing

The ability to create, issue, and monitor financial obligations.

Receive Payments

The ability to collect, verify, and reconcile payments.

Manage Financial Resources

The ability to steward institutional finances responsibly.

Tier 6 — Information Capabilities

Create Information

The ability to capture institutional knowledge accurately.

Protect Information

The ability to ensure confidentiality, integrity, and availability of information.

Analyze Information

The ability to transform information into actionable insight.

Share Information

The ability to provide the right information to the right people at the right time.

Tier 7 — Technology Capabilities

Manage Digital Identity

The ability to securely identify every user.

Deliver Digital Learning

The ability to provide reliable digital educational experiences.

Integrate Systems

The ability to connect institutional technologies into one coherent ecosystem.

Enable Artificial Intelligence

The ability to safely deploy AI in support of education and operations.

Protect Digital Assets

The ability to safeguard systems, infrastructure, and institutional data.

Tier 8 — Quality Capabilities

Measure Performance

The ability to evaluate institutional effectiveness.

Improve Processes

The ability to identify inefficiencies and implement better ways of working.

Ensure Compliance

The ability to satisfy legal, regulatory, accreditation, and institutional requirements.

Learn as an Institution

The ability to capture experience, reflect on outcomes, and continuously improve organizational knowledge.

Capability Relationships

Capabilities do not exist independently.

For example:

Attract Learners



Supports



Admit Learners



Supports



Enroll Learners



Supports



Deliver Learning



Supports



Assess Learning



Supports



Develop Learners



Supports



Recognize Achievement

This sequence represents value creation rather than organizational hierarchy.

Capability Maturity

Every capability should be evaluated using a maturity model.

Levels include:

Level 1 – Initial

Activities are inconsistent and dependent on individuals.

Level 2 – Managed

Processes are repeatable but largely manual.

Level 3 – Defined

Standardized institutional processes exist.

Level 4 – Intelligent

Data, automation, and AI enhance decision-making.

Level 5 – Optimized

The capability continuously improves through evidence, innovation, and institutional learning.

Closing Statement

The Capability Model defines what Tiptop Virtual Academy must always be able to accomplish in pursuit of its mission.

Capabilities endure beyond changes in technology, organizational structures, staffing, and educational trends.

By investing in capability rather than merely implementing software or procedures, the Academy builds resilience, adaptability, and long-term excellence.